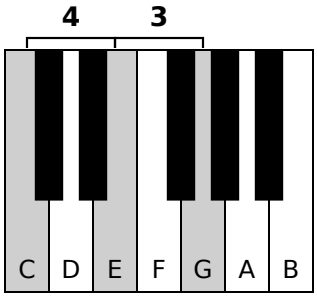
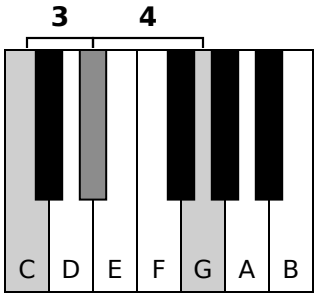
Major and Minor Triads

Every root-position triad contains two 3rds. Which 3rd is on the bottom decides the **quality** of the triad.

- A **major triad** has a major 3rd on the bottom (4 half steps) and a minor 3rd on top (3 half steps).
- A **minor triad** has a minor 3rd on the bottom (3 half steps) and a major 3rd on top (4 half steps).
- In both, the root and the fifth form a perfect 5th (7 half steps).

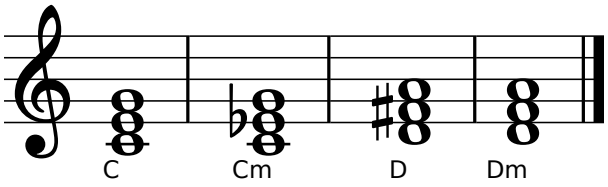


C major: C, E, G (4 + 3)



C minor: C, E♭, G (3 + 4)

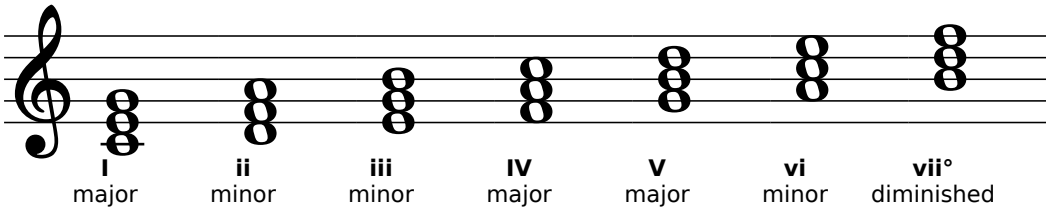
To change a major triad into a minor triad, lower its third by a half step. The root and fifth stay the same. A **chord symbol** names a triad by its root: the letter alone means major, and a small m means minor.



C major, C minor, D major, D minor

Triads in a major key

The triads built on the notes of a major scale always follow the same pattern of qualities. **Roman numerals** number them by scale degree: capital numerals for major triads, small numerals for minor triads. The triad on degree 7 has two minor 3rds; it is a **diminished** triad, marked with a small circle (°).



The triads of C major: major on I, IV, and V; minor on ii, iii, and vi; diminished on vii°.

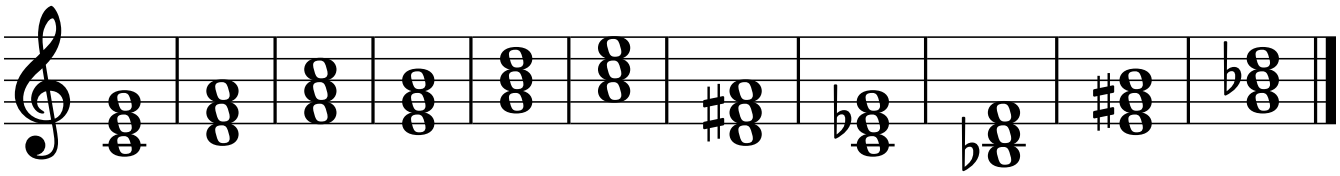
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Name _____ Date _____

Major and Minor Triads

A. Major or minor Write major or minor under each triad.

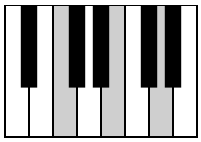
EXAMPLE 1. 2. 3. 4. 5. 6. 7. 8. 9. 10.



major _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____ _____

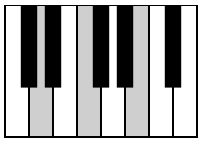
B. Triads on the keyboard Write the chord symbol for each set of shaded keys: the root letter, with m for a minor triad.

EXAMPLE



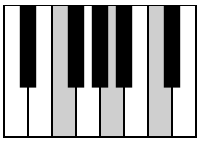
C

1.



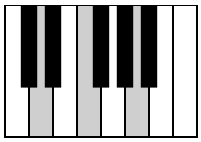
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2.



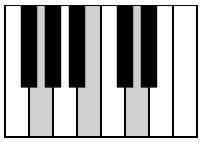
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3.



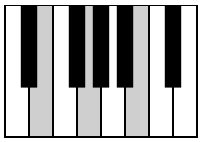
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4.



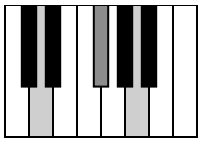
_____

5.



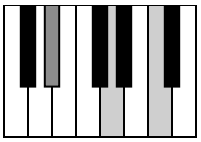
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6.



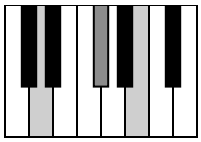
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7.



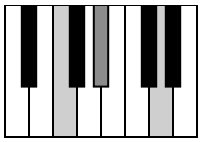
_____

8.



_____

9.



_____

C. Spell the triads Write the three notes of each triad, root first.

EXAMPLE C major: C, E, G

2. A minor: _____
3. D major: _____
4. E minor: _____
5. F major: _____
6. D minor: _____
7. A major: _____
8. B♭ major: _____
9. C minor: _____

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